

LEAD MAGNET | BOULDER BIOLABS

Sterility Testing Readiness Checklist

For ISO 11135 EO validation programs.

Co-located with Boulder Sterilization. One ISO 13485 quality system. No shipping samples across the country.

Sterility Testing Readiness Checklist

Eight questions to answer before your sterility testing program starts.

Pre-Validation Checklist

- **Bioburden recovery efficiency study completed for this device family.**

Required by ISO 11737-1 §6.2. Without RE data, bioburden numbers cannot be defended.

- **Method suitability (B/F) study current for all six USP <71> indicator organisms.**

Validates that your sterility test method recovers contamination if present. Common 483 finding when missing.

- **Half-cycle bioburden samples retained.**

ISO 11135 §9 requires data from half-cycle as well as full-cycle conditions.

- **PCD (process challenge device) defined and validated.**

Most-difficult-to-sterilize position confirmed via biological indicator placement.

- **Sample sizes calculated per protocol (typically 10-30 units depending on phase).**

Statistical sampling plan documented before testing starts.

- **Test article hold time defined.**

How long between aeration and sterility test? Document it - drift here is a real source of failures.

- **Cleanroom environmental data current.**

Routine viable air, surface, and personnel monitoring documented for the period covering your sterility tests.

- **QMS scope statement covers the test methodology.**

Some QMS documents reference USP <71> generally but do not define direct inoculation vs. filtration for your device - close that gap before testing.

Common Pitfalls and How to Avoid Them

"We ran sterility but forgot method suitability."

Halt and run MS first. Do not rerun sterility on a device with no MS coverage.

"We changed material but kept the same MS."

Material change = re-run MS. No exceptions.

"We use a standard rinse fluid."

Specify per USP <71> - fluid A, fluid D, or peptone water depending on device chemistry.

"We did not sub-culture the positive."

Every positive is sub-cultured to genus minimum. Otherwise your investigation has no data.

"Our incubation temperature drifted."

Continuous chart-recording is the only defensible way to demonstrate compliance.

How Boulder BioLabs Helps

- **Method suitability + sterility bundled by default.** No charge for the prerequisite study when sterility is part of the program.
- **Co-located with Boulder Sterilization.** Sterilized samples walk to the lab. No shipping, no chain-of-custody gap, days off your validation timeline.
- **ISO 13485 QMS via Boulder BioMed.** One quality system across sterilization, microbiology, and regulatory.
- **4-hour cycle release option.** For BI-based release programs, 3M Attest rapid-readout indicators confirm cycle efficacy in 4 hours.

Want this checklist filled in for your specific program?

Request a quote and we will return a populated version within one business day.

boulderbiolabs.com/contact